SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

Crafting Second Chances: A Qualitative Study on how Livelihood Skills Shape the Future of Incarcerated Individuals in Provincial Jail Agusan del Norte

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By

KEFLIN KASTINE ALVAREZ
PAUL CHRISTIAN P. DAGAHUYA
MECK RAYAN P. ESPAÑOL
LOVELY G. MONIN
SHIEK DARYL Y. NAVARRO
LEVY B. PABALAN
JULLIANE MARIE C. VARGAS

ADVISER: Sheena Mae A. Gallenero

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the study

Prisons serve a variety of functions within the criminal justice system, not merely to punish lawbreakers. It is intended to safeguard society, deter future offenses, and assist offenders in changing their behavior. However, prisons frequently cannot meet these objectives. With the passage of time, correctional systems evolved from solely punishing to rehabilitating and reintegrating. This shift reflects greater awareness of criminal activity and the belief that individuals can change and become productive members of society again (Criminal Justice System, 2023).

The PDLs are provided with livelihood and technical skills to increase their job opportunities upon their release. In partnership with the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA) and civil Society stakeholders, a total of 112,707 PDLs have undergone training in different industries such as carpentry, electronics, welding, arts and crafts, and small-scale entrepreneurship (BJMP, 2025).

In the Philippines, TESDA guided the incarcerated person to demonstrate their worth by providing a baking training program to improve their practical skills and learn the value of discipline and perseverance, which will ultimately lead them to become financially independent (Belgera, 2023).

The issue is not merely a shortage of workforce. At times, the materials necessary for producing goods are also insufficient. The lack of materials and outdated production equipment negatively affects product marketing and overall productivity. Because of these limitations, producers often fail to meet required order volumes or production quotas.

Delivery also becomes a challenge, especially for bulk orders, due to the absence of a permanent vehicle for product transportation. As a result, customer orders cannot be completed on time because of inadequate resources (Cabuyan et al., 2025).

This research aims to bridge these gaps by examining current marketing strategies for Person Deprived of Liberty (PDL) products within the Bureau of Jail Management, identifying problems encountered in selling products, and delineating possible improvement strategies.

The value of this research lies in its capacity to guide policymakers, prison managers, and community groups in planning and implementing better livelihood programs. By basing recommendations on the actual experiences of PDLs, the research makes not just a contribution to academic literature but also to the establishment of effective practical measures that can reduce recidivism, create a safer public, and foster a more compassionate correctional system in the Philippines.

1.2 REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE

This chapter provides a list of reviews of the related literature (RRL) that describes how Livelihood Skills Shape the Future of Incarcerated Individuals. It also provides foreign literature and local studies by various authors relevant to the research study.

Personal Impact

JPM's Human Development Program (PPI) has been well-designed and implemented as a master plan for the treatment and rehabilitation of prisoners. It begins with different regimental methods to shed harmful habits and attitudes. Gradually, the inputs instill a sense of awareness and sensitivity, and these prisoners are equipped with skills to be available later so that they can be independent as repentant citizens with an awareness of the new spirit.

Even during this skill development, it goes on, reinforcing the soul. These Skills are the primary standby for prisoners, as they ensure job opportunities for them (Rosli et al., 2021).

Al-Issa (2020) states that Resilience among prisoners rests on a high level of endurance of stress stemming from traumatic experiences, like arrest, and the capacity to master life situations, and the strengthening of a positive orientation towards social and political experiences, and the ability to convert stress to an opportunity rather than a disabling threat. The findings also reveal that Resilience correlates with several factors, including secure attachment, supportive relationships, social support systems, conflict relationships, individual and collective aggression, challenges, commitment to principles, and post hoc participation in public events.

Basilio (2022) writes that the District Jail is also reliant on the external medical institution for the determination of the mental health state of the PDLs, and no available Psychiatric Health Doctor. From the results of the study, they can say that a Person Deprived of Liberty suffers from the absence of reasonable and appropriate health care, and also a good hospital for the treatment of the mental illness of the PDLs when the police jail them.

Artizona et al (2019) explain that the occurrence of depression of PDLs was a result of (1) biological factors such as the issue in their hygiene, cell unit, economic and physical issues (2), psychological factors include the concerns and feelings that hurt the mental statuses of the PDLs and (3) the social factors that include family problems, no friends and abuse while in custody.

Positive thinking is an effective tool for self-improvement. It molds our character and makes us the best version of ourselves. One of its main advantages is that it changes our mindset. Positive thinkers see problems as opportunities to learn and grow, even in

challenging situations. It is an optimistic approach that creates mental and emotional balance. It enables us to wake up every morning feeling hopeful and purposeful and feel more joy and satisfaction. Mariano and J. L. (2024).

In the study of Jordan L Mariano (2024) his participants state that “I learned how to socialize inside the institution when there was an activity and we were in one group. That is the time we constantly communicate and socialize with other PDLs, especially with the participants of the said activities”. It implies that PDLs can communicate effectively and clearly to others which is crucial for building and maintaining positive relationships. The result corroborates the statement of Herrity (n.d.), which states that social skills are important because they can help you communicate more effectively and efficiently and, as a result, help you build, maintain, and grow relationships with colleagues, clients, and new contacts. These skills are important to maintain and improve no matter your position, industry, or experience level.

Newton et al (2018). The lack of employment opportunities can lead individuals to commit more offenses. Compared with little, little is understood about the effect of vocational education and training initiatives on re-offending. Much of the prior research in this field has not controlled for or adjusted for selection bias. The article summarizes findings from a systematic review that considers only studies that employed experimental or quasi-experimental designs to assess the outcomes of vocational training and employment programs among adult offenders.

The review, based on these studies, identifies key characteristics of programs with the most favorable outcomes and recommends selection criteria for those with the most significant potential to benefit from prison vocational education and training. Offenders who have mental illnesses can fall into a cycle of decompensation where the assignment to

restrictive housing creates deteriorating mental health and behaviors that, in turn, lead to a further restrictive housing assignment. In addition, Exposure to restrictive housing is linked with deteriorating both mental health and physical health, such as self-injury. Restrictive housing residents have hyper-responsive environmental factors, mood disorders, self-control problems, and aggression (Remch et al., 2021).

They also face special risk factors related to being incarcerated, including single-cell confinement, hope of serving a life sentence 10, and the institutional setting (e.g., overcrowding, isolation procedures, and violence risk. Stijelja, S., & Mishara, B. L. (2022).

The behavioral changes that lead to mental disorders and prison violence often take place in contexts of inhumane confinement conditions, which are common in Latin American prisons. Inmates undergo a process of adaptation that can include injury and aggression, and in some cases, overcrowding, hunger, and disease during imprisonment (Gómez-Figueroa, H., & Camino-Proaño, A., 2022).

Internationally, governments and security organs have institutionalized psycho-behavioral reform programs for offenders (Larsen, 2019). Manka et al. (2021) suggested a range of interventions representing a small fraction of the numerous initiatives facilitated by the court system, at times in Collaboration with local agencies and institutions. Specific programs directly target certain groups of offenders, for example, ex-PDLs and high-risk youth. Regardless of the differing criminological jargon, individuals in penal institutions undergo personal transformation.

According to Patterson (2022), inmates who take part in educational and vocational programs often experience positive personal changes. Programs such as literacy classes, continuing education, and hands-on job training like carpentry, tailoring, welding, or computer

skills help inmates build confidence in themselves and develop discipline and responsibility. As they learn new skills and see their own progress, their behavior inside the facility improves, and they feel more prepared to find work after release, which helps lower the chance of committing crimes again.

Kakupa (2021), reported that inmates themselves describe these programs as transformative, helping them feel more responsible, disciplined, and capable of making positive choices.

The National Academies of Sciences (2022) further pointed out that behavioral success is not just about avoiding crime it also includes emotional well-being, social integration, and the ability to take on meaningful roles in the community.

According to Hunt, Saran, Banks, White, and Kuper (2022) emphasized that livelihood programs align with globalization goals, addressing widespread issues such as poverty, labor shortages, rising unemployment, and limited access to quality education. These programs play a crucial role in mitigating these challenges and ensuring that marginalized groups, including Persons with Disabilities (PWD) and Persons Deprived of Liberty (PsDL), benefit from free livelihood and skills development opportunities.

Reintegration into society after incarceration is often hindered by social stigma, limited economic opportunities, and restricted access to sustainable livelihoods. At the Iwahig Prison and Penal Farm (IPPF), rehabilitation programs aim to equip Persons Deprived of Liberty (PDLs) with vocational skills through partnerships with TESDA, Western Philippine University, and the Department of Agriculture. These programs include High-Value Crops Production, Cashew and Coconut Plantation, Copra Making, Granary Management, Animal Husbandry, Agroforestry, Property and Vermi Composting, Bilao Making, Beauty Products, Manicure and

Pedicure Services, and Grocery Store Management. IPPF's unique open-air correctional model emphasizes productivity and responsibility, engaging PDLs in activities that mirror real-world business operations (Onsat & Breva, 2023).

We often think of incarceration as something people live through and from which they can ultimately be released. But the reality is that time spent in prisons and jails can create a host of collateral consequences that haunt individuals even after release. As the research shows, incarceration can trigger and worsen symptoms of mental illness and those effects can last long after someone leaves the prison gates. Quandt and Jones (2021).

In accordance with Jordan L Mariano (2024) states that participants experienced economic impact as a result of the increased income because the faculty advocated and facilitated the commercialization of products made by the PDLs. The participants experienced the Social Impact as a result of the improved social skills for the reason that participants greatly improved how they communicate with their peers. Spiritual growth, the participants learned how to pray while inside the institution. Positive outlook, the impact of the activities made the participants realize that better things are waiting for them and it changes the way they think.

Lived Experiences

Ki (2023) also mentioned that the Bureau of Jail Management and Penology has been working diligently to professionalize jail services and ensure the medicines and the necessities of Persons Deprived of Liberty, such as food and rehabilitation materials. Therefore, Faustino and De Guzman in 2022 mentioned that self-harming behavior (SHB) is a serious health problem among persons deprived of liberty, owing to several stressful experiences while under custody.

The Bureau of Jail Management and Penology (BJMP), which is part of the Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG), has provided over 113,000 persons deprived of liberty (PDLs) with the opportunity to rebuild their lives through skills and livelihood training. These initiatives have transformed tales of suffering into tales of hope, like Sandy, who acquired welding skills in prison and is now employed overseas; Lisa, who supports her son with her meager income; and Joy, who found her heart in cooking and aspires to have a small restaurant after release. In the view of DILG Secretary Jonvic Remulla, the mission of the BJMP is more than confining individuals behind the bars of jail; it aims to restore people's dignity, give them compassion, and assist PDLs in reintegrating into society with purpose (DILG, 2025).

UNODC (2022), reports that the lived experience of prisoners can be an integral and often missing element of developing evidence-based policy for supporting rehabilitation. In this sense, prisoners' experiences with training, education and rehabilitation in prison and difficulties with reintegration into society after release were instructive in understanding larger criminal justice and societal patterns in the three countries visited, as well as developing strategies for future research in this area. As noted, prisoners' testimonies were very consistent within each country visited, and quite different among the three countries. It is possible that themes might start to emerge among countries once a larger number are represented in the sample, but for the time being, there was very little overlap between the main obstacles to desistence in Albania, Czechia and Thailand, signalling that such targeted and individualized research is indeed necessary in this field.

The Livelihood Project aimed to equip PDLs with vocational skills training and income-generating capacity, enabling them to become financially independent and reduce their reliance on external assistance. Practical skills courses, including fan manufacturing, basket production, and swab-making, are tailored to meet the needs of the local market, enabling

PDLs to earn a living while in prison. The project also enables PDLs to make meaningful contributions to their families and communities upon release, facilitating their resettlement process from prison back into society (Villanueva et al., 2025).

According to Joe Russo (2019),The backbone of corrections is its workforce. The corrections sector relies on qualified, trained and dedicated staff for effective, professional operations. But today, correctional administrators, particularly those running prisons and jails, are grappling with severe workforce challenges that directly impact mission performance. Those challenges include staff recruitment, selection and retention, training and agency succession planning.

The respondents have listed some of the challenges that impact the performance of the skills acquisition programs. They identified inadequate training materials, the absence of a tutor for professional skills acquisition, and an irregular power supply as key issues. The irregular power supply affects the performance of skills-acquisition programs mainly because most of the facilities used run on electricity. Last but not least, a conducive learning environment also affects the performance of skills acquisition programs (Anas et al., 2024).

Additionally, conditions in jails, the availability of legal resources, and Reintegration programs play significant roles in fostering recidivism or facilitating successful integration into society. To effectively combat crime and ensure public safety, there must be a multifaceted change that addresses the root causes of criminal activity and prioritizes the humane treatment of prisoners. These reforms should prioritize rehabilitation over punishment (Vivares KMS, 2023).

All facilities have inmates working in some capacity, and some have reinstated prison work operations to pre-pandemic levels. All but one prison system operates off-site locations

for its inmate population, and many inmate workers have returned to their off-site work-release assignments. In addition, all states have inmate workers whose work assignments qualify them as frontline essential workers (e.g., firefighters). In a minimum of five states, incarcerated employees are engaged in frontline health positions that expose them more to the risk of contracting COVID-19. However, not a single state applied the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention's recommended vaccination strategy to its inmate population, treating its incarcerated staff as essential workers (Segula et al., 2022).

The project capital is either from the BJMP for BJMP-funded projects or from the shared pool of a group of PDL for non-BJMP-funded projects. Some of the ongoing and most popular livelihood projects of PDL include purses and bags, bead-bonsai, pastry, rugs, paper crafts, and wood crafts. Mariano and J. L. (2024).

Person Deprived of Liberty (PDLs) gain a great deal of experience in jails that correctional institutions often accord little consideration, yet it is vital to PDLs. These are boredom, which impacts their psychological facet, and causes them to endure depression and psychological issues. Thus, teaching them to develop their management strategies during their boredom through training is necessary to equip them with the knowledge and skills related to this. Mariano and J. L. (2024).

The 2025 UNODC brief re-examined prison vocational training and its outcomes. After adjusting for inmates' backgrounds, most benefits on employment and recidivism decreased. Only higher wages from training remained consistently positive. The report warns that training alone is insufficient; program relevance and integration with labor markets are key. Without proper alignment, workplace concerns remain a major obstacle. The brief calls for careful program evaluation and employer partnerships to maximize post-release employment.

For many incarcerated people, one of the greatest anxieties is what lies ahead in the world of work. After prison, the fear of stigma from employers looms large and it's not just about finding a job, but whether their skills will be respected. Duwe and Henry-Nickie (2021) from the Brookings Institution pointed out that many employers don't even recognize prison-based credentials, and this lack of trust can leave formerly incarcerated individuals feeling uncertain and undervalued.

In addition, the modern job market increasingly demands digital literacy, yet incarcerated individuals often lack access to relevant training. A study by Nisser, Gaetz, Fishberg, Soicher, Faruqi, and Long (2024) described a 12-week web design class delivered in prisons across the U.S., where participants learned HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. What's powerful is that the course not only taught technical skills but also boosted students' self-efficacy and confidence about their employability.

Couloute and Kopf (2018), state that One of the primary concerns for people being released from prison is finding a job. But as our analysis illustrates, formerly incarcerated people are almost five times more likely than the general public to be unemployed, and many who are employed remain relegated to the most insecure jobs. Our analysis also shows that formerly incarcerated people of color and women face the worst labor market disadvantages despite being more likely to be looking for jobs.

Schnepel (2017) found that these negative perceptions can make finding a job feel almost impossible. Labriola (2021) added that even when jobs are available, low wages, instability, and lack of benefits make employment risky, leaving former inmates vulnerable to returning to crime. Inside prisons, workplace concerns aren't just about the future they start during training. Limited equipment, outdated tools, and inconsistent schedules can make it hard for inmates to practice fundamental skills (Gleason, 2024). Beyond technical skills,

practical barriers such as lack of ID, transportation difficulties, and weak community support still make finding and keeping a job challenging (McNeeley, 2023).

Allowing incarcerated individuals to participate in work programs holds great potential for rehabilitation and reintegration efforts. However, due to the penal nature of prison work and the extreme power imbalance between carceral workers and their superiors, incarcerated workers are in an especially vulnerable position in the workplace. To fully realize, rather than undermine, the rehabilitative potential of prison work programs, incarcerated workers must be afforded increased protections and avenues for remedies under the FLSA and OSH Act. Without adequate avenues to raise concerns about inadequate compensation or unsafe conditions, prison work programs compromise the human rights of their workers in an environment ripe for abuse and exploitation. Meredith Mast(2025).

Program Effectiveness

Samilo et al. (2020) discovered that "livelihood programs have the potential to be successful in transitioning inmates from the prison to the workplace. Through such programs, inmates can also acquire useful employability skills that can translate to hiring opportunities upon release.".

Based on Anas et al. (2024), reform programs, referred to as skills-acquisition programs, include a wide range of training such as carpentry, welding, tailoring, catering, dressing/barbing, plumbing, and painting, among others. These skills acquisition programs are for reformation, rehabilitation, and criminal activity reduction, particularly in the case of convicts who are predominantly youths. Inmates in the prisons participated in vocational skills-acquisition programs, which have significantly improved the socio-economic well-being of the inmates in the study area.

Edwards (2021), in a study titled "Prisoners' Perspectives on Limited Rehabilitative Program Opportunities" examined the 49 male inmates to their views about limited rehabilitative program opportunities and The findings indicate that the operational infrastructures of the prison hindered the access to the programs, and the study's blocked accsess adversely impacted the participants, not getting required rehabilitative programming, and independently, being affected by the act of disenfranchisement from services.

The Department of Science and Technology, Davao Region, through its regional office in Davao del Norte, conducted a practical training session for persons deprived of liberty (PDLs) at the Davao Prison and Penal Farm (DPPF), Braulio E. Dujali, Davao del Norte. The training allowed 24 maximum-security PDLs from the Maximum-Security A compound to engage in learning directly through product development, material safety, and packaging methods as part of a non-food livelihood activity. By allowing the PDLs to improve their livelihood skills through the production of laundry bar soap and detergent powder, it will provide productive rehabilitation when they return to society (Philippine Information Agency, 2024).

Vocational programs are offered in all Minnesota Department of Corrections (MnDOC) facilities. These programs result in post-secondary certificates or diplomas that are industry-recognized and certified. For example, the National Center for Construction Education and Research certifies the Cabinetry, Cabinet Making, Dry Wall, and Painting/Decorating programs, while the Minnesota Board of Cosmetologist Examiners and the Minnesota Barber Board awards licenses to graduates of the Cosmetology and Barber programs. As there is a need to address “soft skills” related to employment, all vocational programs include Career and Employability Skills training. All instructors hold up-to-date credentials issued by the

Minnesota Correctional Education Center (MCEC). In 2018, 578 individuals obtained a vocational certificate, diploma, or license (MnDOC, 2019).

Al-Issa (2020), in a research called "Psychological Resilience among Palestinian Adolescent Ex-detainees in Israeli Jails," determines the factors that influence the psychological Resilience of Palestinian adolescent ex-detainees of Israeli prisons. The sample consists of ten adolescent ex-detainees, ranging in age from seventeen to nineteen. The results, instead of a resiliency in prisons, are premised upon a strong tolerance of stress due to traumatic experiences, like arrest, and control over life events, coupled with reinforcement of a positive attitude towards social and political experiences, and the ability to convert stress into an opportunity rather than a crippling threat. The findings also indicate that Resilience is related to several factors, including secure attachment, supportive relationships, social support systems, conflictual relationships, personal and collective aggression, challenges, commitment to principles, and post hoc participation in public events.

Based on Haas and Spence (2017), existing research lacks data on users' perceptions of correctional service quality. It is unable to provide an adequate understanding of the effectiveness of in-prison or post-release correctional programs.

Financial disability is the biggest problem they encounter while they are in prison and after they come out. Economics is a giant that spawns a host of other variables, such as crime and social abuse. A drastic loss of earnings due to the imprisonment of a popular family member results in the abrupt cessation of earnings and social injustice (Lashari et al., 2023).

Several Western nations are engaged in developing and modifying vocational and educational programs, especially for prisoners, to the extent that, when released, prisoners feel responsible and accountable citizens of the nation by earning their own livelihoods. A

perfect earning life will enable them to live a decent life, increase their standard of living, and boost their confidence (Efrat Shoham et al., 2017; Khan, Lashari & Iqbal, 2022; Zehra, Lashari & Naz, 2023).

Lebbie (2021) emphasized that programs including hands-on experiences like apprenticeships or small production task help inmates practice real-world skills, which in turn increases their chances of employment and lowers recidivism.

Connell, Kinner, and colleagues (2023) added that vocational programs improve job stability and readiness, while Chloupis et al. (2025) found that tailored vocational training significantly improves employment prospects and reduces reoffending. Together, these findings show that vocational programs not only teach skills but also give inmates confidence, direction, and hope for life after prison.

For instance, in Ireland's Mountjoy Jail, online access to university courses was provided, and universities in the United States continued or initiated new courses for incarcerated individuals via online platforms (Global Prison Trends, 2021).

Ilechukwu and Ugwuozor (2024) reported that vocational training helps inmates gain practical skills that can lead to real job opportunities once they leave prison.

McNeeley (2023), investigates whether incarcerated individuals who earned vocational certificates while imprisoned had better employment and recidivism outcomes after their release. The study used propensity-score matching to control for selection bias between those who obtained certificates and those who did not. Surprisingly, after matching, the study found no significant difference in recidivism or employment between the two groups. This suggests that simply earning a certificate may not guarantee better reintegration outcomes under certain conditions. McNeeley argues for a more holistic model: combining

education with risk-needs-responsivity frameworks, community-employer linkages, and reentry support. The research underscores that the quality of training and post-release support may be just as important as the credential itself.

Incarcerated individuals face numerous challenges when reintegrating into society, including finding employment and earning a living wage. Vocational training programs in prisons aim to provide inmates with the skills and knowledge they need to find employment and reduce the likelihood of recidivism (Australian Institute of Criminology (2020).

However, the effectiveness of these programs can be impacted by factors such as overcrowding in prisons, punitive criminal policies, and a shortage of social protection services in the community (UNODC, 2022).

Research has shown that vocational training programs can be effective in promoting successful reentry and reducing recidivism rates among incarcerated individuals (Australian Institute of Criminology (2020).

In the study of Jordan L Mariano (2024) his participants state that “We are grateful and thankful for your efforts in coming especially when you bought and sell our products because it is really a very big help to us financially”. It implies that the skills of the PDLs in making handicraft items is beneficial for them. Increased financial gain through the livelihood program presents income-generating activities to PDL during their confinement where they can earn for their upkeep and financial support to their families. The capital for the livelihood project is either from BJMP for BJMP-funded projects or from the common fund of a group of PDL for non-BJMP-funded projects. Examples of continuing and most popular livelihood projects of PDL are bags and purses, bonsai made of beads, pastries, rugs, paper crafts, and wood crafts.

1.3 Theoretical framework

The two theories that anchor this research are Rehabilitation Theory, and Self-Efficacy. Rehabilitation Theory focuses on rehabilitating and readjusting offenders for integration into society through learning and vocational training (Cullen & Gendreau, 2000). Self-efficacy theory focuses on the idea that people's beliefs about their ability influence their actions, motivation, and personal growth (Albert Bandura, 1977; 1986).

These theories inform this study's core questions: How livelihood Skills influence the future of prisoners, how livelihood schemes impact their in-house workplace attitudes, and what challenges they encounter in gaining these skills.

Rehabilitation Theory

Rehabilitation Theory, Cesare Lombroso emphasizes rehabilitating offenders more than punishing them. It emphasizes the utility of counseling, education, and vocational skills training in reducing recidivism and enabling successful reintegration into society (Cullen & Gendreau, 2000). Rehabilitation Theory guides this research into how livelihood programs within the Agusan del Norte Provincial Jail assist detainees in acquiring work habits, enhancing behavior, and preparing for life after release.

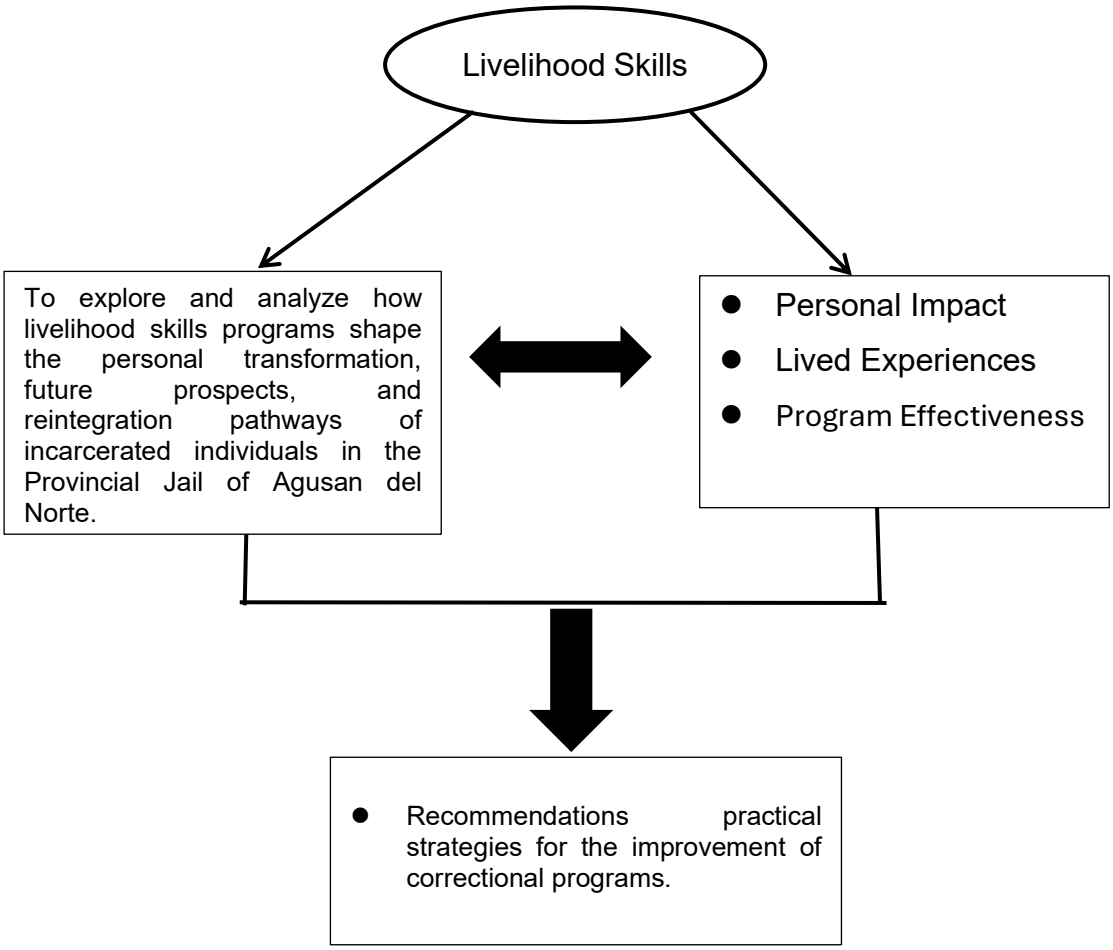
Applied to this research, Rehabilitation Theory explains how livelihood programs can shape inmates' futures by providing them with productive skills and work habits. It also sheds light on how the same programs affect work behavior, e.g., responsibility, punctuality, and cooperation. It also calls attention to problems such as scarcity of resources, overcrowding, or untrained personnel, which could make it more difficult for the inmates to maximize the benefits of rehabilitation programs within the facility.

Self-Efficacy Theory

Albert Bandura's Self-Efficacy Theory (1977; 1986) highlights that people's beliefs about their capacity affect their behavior, motivation, and self-development. In the correctional environment, this theory accounts for how inmates participating in livelihood programs acquire a sense of competence and confidence through learning new skills.

Through learning and applying new competencies, their self-efficacy is enhanced, leading to positive behavioral change and individual development. This process helps them reshape their identity from offenders to capable, responsible, and productive members of society. Thus, the theory supports the idea that livelihood skills training serves as a tool for rehabilitation, empowering prisoners to craft meaningful second chances for themselves and their families.

1.4 Schematic Diagram



1.5 General Objectives

To explore and analyze how livelihood skills programs shape the personal transformation, future prospects and reintegration pathways of incarcerated individuals in the Provincial Jail of Agusan del Norte.

1.6 Specific Objectives

1. To examine the lived experiences of incarcerated individuals participating in livelihood skills programs and the processes through which these skills are acquired during incarceration.

2. To analyze inmates' perceptions of the influence of livelihood skills training on their self-worth, personal agency, and outlook toward life after release.

3. To explore the role, challenges, and limitations of livelihood skills programs in preparing incarcerated individuals for social reintegration and lawful employment, with implications for policy and program enhancement.

1.7 Scope and Limitations

The research "Crafting Second Chances: A Qualitative Study on How Livelihood Skills Shape the Future of Incarcerated Individuals" aims to investigate how livelihood skills shape the futures of incarcerated individuals and the impact of livelihood programs at the Provincial Jail, Agusan del Norte.

This research will be carried out during the first and second semesters of the 2025–2026 school year. This research focuses only on the chosen inmates of the Provincial Jail, Agusan del Norte, who are presently engaged in livelihood activities. The research focuses on identifying workplace issues faced by prisoners, examining improvements in their vocational

skills, probing the behavioral effects of livelihood activities, and determining the challenges they encounter in learning these skills.

1.8 Definition of Terms

These are the definitions given for the terms used herein. "Crafting Second Chances: A Qualitative Study on How Livelihood Skills Shape The Future of Incarcerated Individuals in Provincial Jail, Agusan Del Norte" to make it easier for the readers to understand.

Incarcerated. An individual in the Provincial jail in Agusan Del Norte serves their punishment for the negative thing they did.

Jail. A Place where incarcerated individuals serve their sentence.

Livelihood. This is how Incarcerated Individuals live inside the jail. It provides support to them financially, through work, skills, or activities. Moreover, it can support their income, help them sustain themselves, and meet their basic needs.

Livelihood Program. An initiative that provides the offender with a chance to earn money while they are within the prison walls.

Program. Provided by the BJMP to Detainees, specifically Tuna Processing and Value-added Product, Bamboo Handicrafts, Cake Decorating Training, Skirting, Handcrafted Bags, Bead Bracelet Making. The aim is to rehabilitate prisoners through livelihood programs and to equip them with the skills to lead productive lives upon release.

Second Chances. Refers to an opportunity for a second try by the jailbirds to show themselves that they can transform while remaining within jail, so that they can become better people when they return to society.

Skills. Refers to the new skills they acquired within the jail.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter discusses the research methods the researchers will use to conduct the study, including the research design, data collection, and data analysis.

2.1 Research Design

The research strategy used in this study is a qualitative, narrative approach utilizing in-depth interviews to explore how Livelihood Skills shape the future of incarcerated individuals. This study seeks to understand and describe the personal stories and lived experiences of incarcerated individuals who have participated in Livelihood Skills Programs, focusing on their workplace concerns, vocational impact, and behavioral changes over time.

In narrative research, the primary goal is to collect and interpret stories that reveal how individuals make meaning of their experiences. Through the sharing of personal narratives, this study aims to highlight how participation in Livelihood Skills Programs has influenced the participants' perspectives, choices, and future aspirations during and after incarceration.

Participants for this qualitative study will be selected using a purposive sampling technique. This method allows the researcher to deliberately choose participants who have directly engaged in Livelihood Skills Programs at the Provincial Jail of Agusan del Norte and who are willing to share their personal life stories. Selection will be conducted in a non-obtrusive manner, ensuring respectful and ethical interaction between the researcher and the participants.

Purposive sampling is appropriate for this study as it enables the researcher to identify individuals whose experiences can provide rich, detailed narratives relevant to the research objectives. Through these collected stories, the study will generate qualitative insights that offer a deeper understanding of how Livelihood Skills Programs shape the lives and futures of incarcerated individuals, thereby fulfilling the overall goals of the research.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

This Qualitative Research uses personal, one-on-one interviews to determine the livelihood skills that shape the futures of incarcerated individuals at the Provincial Jail in Agusan del Norte, Butuan City. The selected participants will be interviewed using an open-ended guide to gather their experiences and those related to livelihood training. The interviews will be recorded with participants' permission, and field notes will be taken to complement other observations. Confidentiality and voluntary participation will be ensured throughout the study.

2.3 Research Environment, Population, and Sample

This qualitative study will be conducted in Agusan del Norte Provincial Jail, a provincial government-owned penal institution in Libertad, Butuan City. The jail is a critical organization in the rehabilitation process of persons deprived of liberty (PDLs). The place for this study is significant because it is where livelihood skills training is provided, and it directly influences the day-to-day lives, prospects, and issues of the inmates.

This research will use conversational partners from the Agusan del Norte Provincial Jail in Butuan City, Agusan del Norte, Philippines. Participants will be Incarcerated Individuals, with a sampling range of at least eight (8) up to a maximum of ten (10). The identity and personal information of the participants will be kept confidential during the research process.

The in-depth interviews will be held inside the penal facility for security and safety purposes. All rules, regulations, and protocols will be followed to the letter during these interactions. This information will be used to answer the research questions, offer insights for future research, and recommend practices to improve the policy of Incarcerated Individuals.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

The study will be conducted by observing and complying with standard protocols, particularly in protecting the confidentiality and rights of the participants. A letter of request was forwarded to the officer in charge of Agusan del Norte Provincial Jail to seek permission for the researchers to conduct the study. Additionally, another letter will be sent to the office of the officer in charge of the Agusan del Norte Provincial Jail to interview the incarcerated individuals . The participants are Persons Deprived of Liberty (PDL) who have experience with Livelihood Programs. Interviews will be conducted with a maximum of ten (10) and a minimum of eight (8) selected participants, all of whom are Incarcerated Individuals at Agusan del Norte Provincial Jail, and each participant was accompanied by an informed consent form.

The researchers will uphold the dignity and confidentiality of the participants. Qualitative data will be gathered during the interviews, with participants' statements recorded as voice recordings and/or video recordings, which will be blurred to maintain their anonymity. Furthermore, all interactions will be documented using mobile phones. After the information is collected, it will be examined, organized, analyzed, and interpreted. Throughout the research process, the participants will remain confidential and safeguarded. The conclusion and recommendations will be formulated to provide insights for future studies and to inform policies aimed at improving the experiences and programs related to Rehabilitation of Incarceration Individuals. These findings will serve as a foundation for enhancing the overall

effectiveness of such initiatives.per se but are well-grounded in the words of those who have lived through these.

2.5 Ethical Standard

The study entitled "Crafting Second Chances: A Qualitative Study on how Livelihood Skills Shape the Future of Incarcerated Individuals in Provincial Jail Agusan del Norte" shall proceed with utmost care and in compliance with ethical standards to safeguard the rights and welfare of the participants. The research shall ensure it is in accordance with decent research practice and treats all information in good faith, respect, and honesty.

A. Intellectual Property Rights

This research will not entail the development of new technologies, products, or processes that need to be protected by patents. It focuses on the experiences of jail detainees participating in livelihood programs at Agusan del Norte Provincial Jail. The products of this research, such as reports, analyses, and interview transcripts, will be original works drafted by the researchers. These materials will be covered by copyright laws logos, symbols, or brands will be used to ensure the focus remains on participants' voices, perspectives, and actual experiences in learning and practicing livelihood skills.

B. Informed Consent

Before joining the program, prisoners will be thoroughly informed about the goal, aims, and reach of the study. The participants will be informed of the procedures, potential risks, and benefits clearly and straightforwardly. Written consent will be obtained from all participants to ensure their participation is voluntary. They will also be told that they can refuse to answer any question at any point in time or withdraw from the study without any

adverse consequences. This makes participation dependent on a complete understanding and mutual respect.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

All private data collected from the participants will be handled with utmost confidentiality. They will not be identified in any published work or presentation. Codes or pseudonyms will replace actual names. All data, including audio recordings and written observations, will be stored securely in password-protected folders accessible only to the researchers. If any information must be disclosed for scholarly purposes, written authorization will be obtained from the participants in advance.

D. Voluntary Participation

Voluntary participation in this study will occur. Incarcerated participants will be free to choose whether to take part. They can withdraw at any time without facing any punishment or repercussions. The researchers will ensure that participants are not pressured or coerced in any manner. This practice maintains respect for personal autonomy and ensures that all participants feel safe and at ease during the study.

E. Minimization of Harm

All attempts will be made to avoid physical, emotional, or psychological harm to the participants. Interviews will be conducted with empathy, patience, and respect for participants' personal boundaries. If any topic causes discomfort or distress, participants may skip the question or end the interview. Should any emotional distress occur, Appropriate referrals for counseling or mental health support will be offered. The research team will also be trained to identify signs of distress and to respond in a caring and supportive manner. No animals are involved.

F. Beneficence

The research will advance the well-being of prisoners by demonstrating how livelihood programs can assist in rehabilitation and individual development.Through their experiences, the researchers hope to yield insights that can improve livelihood programs in prisons. Findings will be disseminated to jail administrators, policymakers, and relevant stakeholders to inform programs for rehabilitation and recidivism reduction. Participants will also receive a summary of the results, allowing them to see how their input contributed to the research.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Participants will be recruited in a manner that is equitable and fair. Participants will be those who have undergone livelihood programs at Agusan del Norte Provincial Jail, and they may be selected without regard to sex, age, or length of sentence. There will be no bias against individuals due to social or personal background. What has been gathered is representative of different experiences, and the data gives equal opportunity to participate.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

To provide reliability and accuracy, well-established methods of data analysis and collection will be utilized. Interviews will be audio-recorded with consent and transcribed with care. Data will be reviewed several times to double-check correctness and consistency. Researchers will note potential sources of bias and limitations that might affect interpretation. Quality Control measures will also be adopted for maintaining the credibility and integrity of the findings.

I. Transparency in Reporting

All findings and data will be presented honestly, clearly, and with no distortion. Methodology, study results, and limitations will be described in full detail for transparency. The researchers will also include a statement affirming that the study maintained ethical integrity throughout. Any AI tools used in writing or data analysis will be honestly declared to uphold honesty and academic integrity.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

The researchers will not utilize any patented or copyrighted materials without first seeking the permission of the rightful owners. All materials to be used in the study will be either original works or properly cited public sources. The research complies with intellectual property rights and upholds ethical academic practice.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

As the research in this case involves only human subjects, ethical concerns will focus solely on protecting their rights and welfare. They will be informed of the purpose, procedures, and any possible consequences of the study before their involvement. The research will be conducted with empathy and respect to ensure no harm is caused to participants and that their dignity is maintained throughout.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

AI tools like ChatGPT, Blackbox, and Grammarly. It will be utilized responsibly to aid in writing, structuring, and analyzing data. The tools will be used only to enhance clarity, efficiency, and thematic accuracy, not as substitutes for the researchers' critical judgment. The

Responsible use of these tools will help ensure that the data is appropriately managed and the results are meaningful and credible.

M. Ethical Approval

Before starting data collection, ethical approval will be obtained from the ethics committee of Saint Michael College of Caraga. This step ensures that all procedures meet ethical research standards and that the rights and safety of all participants are protected. The application will contain complete information regarding the aims, methodology, and ethical measures of the study. By obtaining institutional approval, researchers demonstrate their commitment to conducting responsible, humane, and respectful research that respects the dignity of incarcerated individuals.

